

determined to do her part. Then in 1944, the princess joined the women's branch of the British Army. In the ATS (Auxiliary Territorial Service), she learned to drive and repair army trucks. The King was impressed to meet his grease-stained princess, who wasn't afraid of getting dirty. Like all ATS members, the princess was given a number and her details recorded: "Number 230873. Second Subaltern Elizabeth Alexandra Mary Windsor. Age 18. Eyes: blue. Hair: brown. Height: 5 ft 3 in."

That same year, Elizabeth made her first live speech in public, at a London children's hospital. Although still shy, she had grown into an impressive young lady.

War in Europe ended in May 1945. In London and other big cities, people partied to mark the Allies' victory. Elizabeth stood with her parents on the palace balcony, waving to the huge mass of people below. With them was Winston Churchill, who had led the British Government since 1940. That evening, the two princesses slipped out to join the crowds singing and dancing in the streets.

